

magnified in a globalised environment where subtle differences in language and style exist across geographies. The English used in America differs from that used in India and a good grammar check feature is able to identify and correct the mistakes automatically. In advanced packages, this feature extends to languages outside of the Roman script such as Hindi and Russian as well. It's important to ensure that this feature is well developed and adequately functional for any office suite to have any real value.

- ▶ **Spelling Check:** Just as grammar check ensures correct syntax and style of language, spelling check makes sure that words are spelled accurately depending on the language of choice. The minor differences between words common across languages and even those oddly spelled words in languages such as French or Spanish can be found out quite easily with a spell check feature. A good office suite comes bundled with a vast dictionary which can be customised and helps ensure



Grammar and spellchecks are very useful

- that common mistakes in copy-editing and proofing of a document are automatically corrected with as limited waste of time as possible. It's also helpful if these dictionaries are updatable via the internet to ensure that they remain relevant with the changing use of language.
- ▶ **Thesaurus:** There will always be times when the right word escapes the users' mind. You know what you want to say and even have a word for it, but it's not the right word. An effective office suite comes with an in-built thesaurus lexicon, which allows you to look up words that are similar in meaning so that you can pick the right one. This feature is also effective in improving your own vocabulary as you work and essential towards using language in a more accurate manner as you're writing.
- ▶ **Search and Replace:** Many times it becomes necessary to make vast yet consistent changes across a document, such as replacing a name which was mistakenly used. The Search option helps you locate a search variable from within vast quantities of text and replace incorrect words or data with the correct one using the Replace tool. In combination, the Search and Replace tool comes with the option of making changes across the whole document with the single click of a button — just insert